

BIODIVERSITY 3 - World Café

Leipzig scoping workshop -- Eric Pante, 2026-09-18

Link [here](#).

Moderator instructions

Only 4 of these 8 questions will be discussed. We will let the participants decide which, using the Wooclap questionnaire.

For each of the four questions selected for discussion, try to...

1. *Clarify the ambition*: What problem are we trying to solve? Why does this require a research programme rather than existing initiatives?
2. *Identify knowledge gap(s)*: What is currently missing? Where are the important scientific, methodological, institutional or societal barriers?
3. *Make it actionable*: What kinds of projects would address this? What would successful projects produce or change?
4. *Define the thematic boundaries*: What should not be included? How can we avoid making the CRA so broad that it loses focus?

When you start with your group:

1. state the core question, bold and italics in the sections below
2. either to get things started (if participants are not inspired) or as follow-ups, use the proposed "sub-questions"
3. the list of keywords can help you articulate the answer, or as a basis to help you take notes
4. "possible call implications" help you capture implications for the call: Should this be a core objective, a cross-cutting principle, or simply an eligible topic?

1. Long-term biodiversity data → action

How can long-term biodiversity data be better used to support concrete action and decision-making?

Useful sub-questions

- What kinds of decisions or actions should biodiversity monitoring ultimately inform?
- Where are the biggest gaps within this chain: data collection → knowledge → decision → action?
- What prevents existing long-term datasets from being used effectively?
- Should projects be expected to work with decision-makers or other societal actors from the beginning, rather than only disseminating results at the end?
- Can participants give an example of a project that succeeded at linking monitoring and action?

Keywords to help get discussions started

- policy and management
- conservation/restoration
- early warning systems / tipping points
- adaptive management
- indicators and targets
- scenario development (sensus IPBES or not!)
- evidence-to-action mechanisms
- co-design with users

Possible call implication

Projects should demonstrate a credible pathway from long-term biodiversity evidence to a concrete decision, intervention or societal action.

2. Genuine transdisciplinary biodiversity monitoring

How can biodiversity monitoring be designed and implemented through genuinely transdisciplinary approaches, involving societal actors from the outset?

Useful sub-questions

- What do we mean by transdisciplinarity in the context of biodiversity monitoring?
- Who should participate beyond researchers: policymakers, Indigenous Peoples, local communities, NGOs, land managers, industry, citizens, etc.?
- What distinguishes transdisciplinary co-production from consultation, stakeholder engagement or citizen science?
- Should transdisciplinarity be mandatory for every project, or should the call support different degrees/forms of collaboration?

Keywords to help get discussions started

- co-definition of questions
- co-design of monitoring
- co-production of knowledge
- shared ownership
- dealing with power asymmetries
- trust and long-term relationships
- resources for societal partners
- recognition of non-academic contributions

Possible call implication

Transdisciplinarity should concern not only dissemination or uptake, but the formulation of questions, monitoring design, interpretation and pathways to action.

3. Traditional Ecological Knowledge / Indigenous & Local Knowledge

How can Traditional Ecological Knowledge, Indigenous and Local Knowledge, and other knowledge systems be meaningfully integrated with scientific knowledge?

Useful sub-questions

- What kinds of knowledge can contribute to long-term biodiversity monitoring that conventional scientific monitoring may miss?
- How can different knowledge systems be brought together without reducing one to a source of data for the other?
- What does meaningful participation and Indigenous/local leadership look like?
- How should issues of data sovereignty, intellectual property, consent and CARE principles be addressed?
- Are we talking about integrating knowledge, braiding knowledge systems, or creating spaces where different knowledge systems can remain distinct but inform one another?

Keywords to help get discussions started

- Indigenous leadership
- TEK/ILK
- intergenerational knowledge
- oral histories
- community monitoring
- local indicators

- language
- data sovereignty
- reciprocity
- benefit sharing
- ethical protocols

Possible call implication

Projects involving Indigenous or local knowledge should be designed around reciprocity, rights, appropriate governance and knowledge-holder priorities—not simply the extraction of additional biodiversity observations.

4. Better use of existing long-term datasets

How can we make better use of existing, long-term biodiversity datasets, including historical, community-based, citizen-science and monitoring data?

Useful sub-questions

- What prevents us from exploiting the enormous amount of biodiversity information already collected?
- Which kinds of legacy datasets are particularly underused?
- Is the major challenge data accessibility, interoperability, quality, metadata, analytical methods—or something else?
- How can we combine heterogeneous datasets without erasing their different origins, biases and purposes?
- added value of BD3: What could BIODIVERSITY3 enable that individual data owners or existing infrastructures cannot do alone?

Keywords to help get discussions started

- data rescue
- digitisation
- historical datasets
- interoperability
- harmonisation
- AI/ML
- statistical integration
- bias correction
- FAIR/CARE
- citizen science
- natural history collections

- LTER/eLTER/ILTER
- Indigenous/community datasets

Possible call implication

The CRA could explicitly prioritise the mobilisation and integration of existing long-term observations, rather than primarily funding the generation of new short-term datasets.

5. Local relevance ↔ global biodiversity assessment

How can biodiversity monitoring be made more relevant to local and regional priorities while still contributing to global biodiversity assessments and targets?

Useful sub-questions

- How can monitoring simultaneously serve local needs and global biodiversity goals?
- Are global indicators currently adequately connected to what matters locally?
- How can local priorities influence the choice of indicators rather than simply being translated into externally defined metrics?
- How should projects deal with differences in scale, indicators, terminology and monitoring priorities?
- Should BIODIVERSITY3 primarily seek to make local monitoring contribute to global assessments, or to make global monitoring frameworks more responsive to local priorities?

Keywords to help get discussions started

- CBD Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework
- national biodiversity strategies
- IPBES
- local indicators
- scale mismatches
- policy relevance
- comparability
- subsidiarity
- local ownership

Possible call implication

Projects should demonstrate two-way connections between local/regional monitoring priorities and international biodiversity frameworks.

6. FAIR + CARE + data governance

How can research and monitoring generate knowledge that is FAIR, accessible and reusable, while respecting CARE principles, data sovereignty and the rights of knowledge holders?

Useful sub-questions

- How can we reconcile open science with legitimate restrictions on sensitive biodiversity and knowledge?
- Which data should be openly accessible, and which should remain controlled?
- How can FAIR and CARE principles be implemented from the beginning of a project, rather than retrospectively?
- Who should have authority over data generated through community or Indigenous partnerships?
- Could a dataset be technically FAIR but still ethically inappropriate to share?

Keywords

- sensitive species locations
- sacred/culturally sensitive knowledge
- Indigenous data sovereignty
- CARE
- FAIR
- metadata
- interoperability
- open infrastructures
- governance
- consent
- data access levels

Possible call implication

Responsible data governance should be treated as part of the research design, with FAIR and CARE considered complementary rather than competing principles.

7. Monitoring biodiversity change, drivers and action effectiveness

How can we design monitoring systems that better capture biodiversity change, its drivers, and the effectiveness of conservation and restoration actions?

Useful sub-questions

- Are we currently monitoring biodiversity status better than we monitor change and its causes?
- How can monitoring distinguish correlation from evidence useful for intervention?
- How can long-term monitoring evaluate whether conservation/restoration actions actually work?
- What combinations of ecological, environmental and socio-economic observations are needed?
- What would we need to measure differently if the purpose of monitoring were not simply to detect biodiversity change, but to determine what can be done about it?

Keywords

- drivers of biodiversity change
- intervention monitoring
- restoration
- management effectiveness
- adaptive management
- ecological thresholds
- early warning systems and tipping points
- socio-ecological indicators

Possible call implication

BIODIVERSITY3 could support monitoring approaches explicitly designed to connect biodiversity trends with their drivers and with the outcomes of management or policy interventions.

8. Lasting partnerships, capacities and infrastructures

How can BIODIVERSITY3 build lasting partnerships, capacities and monitoring infrastructures beyond the lifetime of individual research projects?

Useful sub-questions

- What makes biodiversity monitoring long-term, rather than simply a multi-year project?
- How can research projects strengthen existing monitoring infrastructures rather than create parallel systems?
- What happens to partnerships, data and capacity when the grant ends?
- How can the CRA contribute to institutional and community capacity, particularly in

countries and regions with limited monitoring resources?

- Should long-term sustainability be an expectation of individual projects, or should BIODIVERSITY3 itself invest in mechanisms that sustain the network after the CRA?

Keywords

- LTER/eLTER/ILTER
- national monitoring systems
- community monitoring
- institutionalisation
- capacity building
- training
- infrastructure
- open data infrastructures
- South–South collaboration
- equitable partnerships
- continuity of funding

Possible call implication

Applicants should demonstrate how monitoring, partnerships, data and capacity will persist beyond the project, ideally by connecting to existing long-term infrastructures and institutions.

One final question for every discussion

End each breakout discussion with exactly the same question:

If BIODIVERSITY3 could change only ONE thing about how biodiversity monitoring is currently done, what should that change be?